

Editorial

Dear readers

This time, I plan to share with you what's happening at our end, and how you could support us in doing better.

First, our Facebook page now enjoys the patronage of 29,000 fans! While India now tops the list (it did not, two months ago), we have fans from all across the globe. The top five nations, at the time of writing this piece, are India, Sri Lanka, Indonesia, Argentina, and the United States (in the order of ranking). The LFY team shares the latest Linux and open source news from all across the globe on our Facebook page. The same gets published on our Twitter account, and on LinuxForU.com through a Twitter feed plug-in. Besides what we post, there are over 40 to 50 posts every day, from fans. Some share their experiences, some ask for help, while others respond to these requests for help. And, that's where you can contribute—if you've got a doubt, want to share an experience, or have some exciting news to share, join our Facebook page (www.facebook.com/LinuxForYou) and start connecting with a global open source community.

Second, we have developed the website, LinuxForU.com, and it's been in the beta phase for a few months now. We have been tinkering with its features and also trying to finalise the strategy on sharing our content through the website, while hoping and praying that the sales of the magazines do not drop (they have not, so far, and we thank you all for that).

We have also integrated the website with our main technology portal, EFYTimes.com, thus promoting Linux and open source amongst an audience that likes to read about technology, but may not be supporters of open source, as yet. We hope we will be able to influence some of them to think 'open'. LinuxForU.com will shortly start getting updated at a higher frequency, and not only will we be publishing content from the magazine, but even publishing exclusive content. However, we could do a lot better with your support. We need authors and content managers (those who can publish our print-ready content in a Web-friendly manner). We need subject-matter experts to review some of the content, and also to review and manage user-driven content like 'Tips 'n Tricks'. So, if you want to participate in this project, write to me.

Third, we have initiated a very interesting series on LinuxForU.com, and will be publishing it in the magazine too. It's about recruitment trends related to open source. Our initial goal was to talk to software development firms and figure out whether they recruited open source professionals. If they did, we aimed to report the details on how they went about it, for what type of projects they required talent, what salaries were offered, etc. That still remains our primary goal.

But, while doing this series, we realised that we had to explore another important aspect: are software companies using open source technologies and tools, and, if yes, which ones? What were the overall benefits they enjoyed and what challenges did they overcome? Thus, we hope that this series will not only be useful to the current and future generation of open source techies, but also to all the senior folks, who take strategic decisions with respect to which technologies

and platforms to bet their organisation's future on. We have already published a few such interviews on LinuxForU.com, which are available under the 'Interview' category.

So how can you help in this regard? If your firm has more than 50 software engineers, and uses open source tools for development, let us know. We would like to speak to a few people working in your company about their open source experiences.

Hopefully, by the time this magazine reaches you, fossyellowpages.com (the beta version) would have been launched.

Last but not the least, we are about to launch fossyellowpages.com. I had discussed this project earlier. It's an initiative to create a listing of vendors who provide support for open source solutions, so that it becomes simpler for IT managers and CIOs to seek support. We did initiate the print version in the magazine a year ago, but it was clear from the first month itself that the online version would be a much better platform to connect buyers and sellers of open source solutions. Hopefully, by the time this magazine reaches you, fossyellowpages.com (the beta version) would have been launched.

Here again, your support will be more than welcome. If you know a firm that provides open source solutions, let them know about fossyellowpages.com—they can register themselves for free. If you work for one, let the boss know. If you are the boss, list your organisation immediately. We need to showcase to the world that there is indeed commercial support available for open source, and that CIOs and IT managers can bet their careers on open source. Plus, let us know about any errors or glitches you encounter while using the website. If you feel that a particular screen design or user interface can be improved, we will be happy to hear about it.

That's not all—there's a lot happening on the Open Source India Days front too, but I guess I don't have space left for that. Luckily, we have updated OSDays.com too; so you can get updates about our upcoming event from there.

Best wishes,



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